Sarcococca saligna
Willow-leaf Sweet Box

Family: Buxaceae

Reflective_Mirror: 22 | Passage N_S: 50 | **TOTAL 72**



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 1–3 ft (0.3–0.9 m) high × 1–3 ft (0.3–0.9 m) wide. Compact, suckering with arching stems. Slow to

Sun

Water

Soil
Moderately fertile, moist but well-drained, humus-rich soil. Tolerates a range of soils including clay and sand

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 7–9. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Evergreen with long, narrow, willow-like glossy leaves. Tiny greenish-white winter flowers (mild scent) followed by purple berries. Excellent for shade. Heat and humidity tolerant with moisture. Distinctive foliage among sweet boxes

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to the western Himalaya (Afghanistan to Kumaon, India, Nepal, Pakistan, and extending to other Asian regions). Introduced to cultivation in the early 20th century. Distinctive willow-like foliage

Form
Dense evergreen shrub. Long, narrow lanceolate glossy leaves on erect then arching stems. Tiny greenish-white flowers in winter (less strongly scented than other Sarcococca). Purple berries follow. Suckering habit. Year-round structure. Distinctive willow-leaved sweet box. Milder scent than S. confusa but attractive foliage and purple berries. Excellent shade evergreen. Native to western Himalaya.
Reliable and low maintenance

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in part to full shade with moist, well-drained soil.
Excellent for shade borders, foundations, and underplanting.
Mulch to retain moisture. Minimal pruning.
Low maintenance. Suitable for Atlanta shade gardens

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest-free and low maintenance. Excellent shade performer. Mildly fragrant winter flowers. Berries ornamental.
No serious problems stated as dominant.
Tolerant of dry shade once established

Symptoms

None stated